ST FRANCIS CATHOLIC SECONDARY SCHOOL, LAGOS

The Jesuit-Run Catholic College



ENGLISH STUDIES

JSS 1

First Term

2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

SCHEME OF WORK FOR FIRST TERM

WEEK	ASPECT	TOPIC	BREAKDOWN
1 - 2	SPEECH WORK	ORGANS OF SPEECH	i. definition of terms(organs and speech) ii. identification of the organs of speech (using a diagram) iii. description of each organ
3-4	SPEECH WORK	THE ENGLISH ALPHABET AND SPECH SOUND	i. introduction to the English Alphabets(Lower and Upper Cases) ii. introduction to the English Sound(Speech) System(definition of terms-speech and sound) iii. drawing a link between the Alphabets and Sounds iv. The English Sound system-vowels and consonants-symbols
5-6	SPEECH WORK	WORD FORMATION	i. morpheme, two-letter words, three letter words, phrases, sentences, paragraph- P-Point-main idea E-Evidence-supporting ideas E-Explanation-analyze the evidence, explain why and how it supports your points. L-Link-link ideas back to the main idea NB Speaking in paragraphs ii. syllables-monosyllables, disyllables and polysyllables iii. homonyms iv. homophones v. palindromes vi. synonyms vii. antonyms viii. affixation-prefixes and suffixes ix. etymology of words-Greek and Latin
7-8	STRUCTURE	WORD CLASSES	i. Noun-naming ii. Pronoun-substitute

			iii. Adjective-qualifier iv. Preposition-pointer v. Verb-doing vi. Adverb-additional information vii. Conjunction-joining viii. Interjection-feeling
9	STRUCTURE	ARTICLES	i. definite ii. indefinite/their uses
10	READING	PASSAGES	i. meaning ii. types of passages iii. purposes for reading
11	REVISION		
12	EXAMINATION		

Week 1-2

Date	
Topic	**ORGANS OF SPEECH**
Learning Objectives	By the end of the lesson, students should be able to: 1. Define organs of speech. 2. Explain the meaning of important terms used in speech production. 3. Identify the organs of speech on a diagram. 4. State the functions of each organ of speech. 5. Mention speech sounds produced by some organs.
Insight	The teacher asks the students questions such as: • Which parts of your body do you use when speaking? • Can you talk without opening your mouth? • Which part moves most when you are speaking?
Key words/New terms	Vocal cord, speech, organs, mouth, airstream
Application	The teacher uses conversation among students to illustrate the topic
Summary	The organs of speech are the parts of the body that help us produce speech sounds. They include the lungs, larynx, vocal cords, tongue, lips, teeth, palate, nose, and other organs. Each organ performs a special function in speech production
Student engagement: i. What have I learnt? ii. Skills acquired	
My Question(s)/Evaluation	i.
Action	

ORGANS OF SPEECH

MEANING OF ORGANS OF SPEECH

Organs of speech are the parts of the human body that work together to produce speech sounds.

These organs help us to speak clearly by controlling the flow of air and shaping different sounds.

Important Terms

1. Speech

Speech is the expression of thoughts and ideas through spoken language.

2. Speech Sound

A speech sound is any sound used in speaking a language.

Examples:

- /p/
- /b/
- /m/
- /t/

3. Articulation

Articulation is the movement of the organs of speech to produce different sounds.

4. Articulators

Articulators are the organs that help produce speech sounds.

Examples:

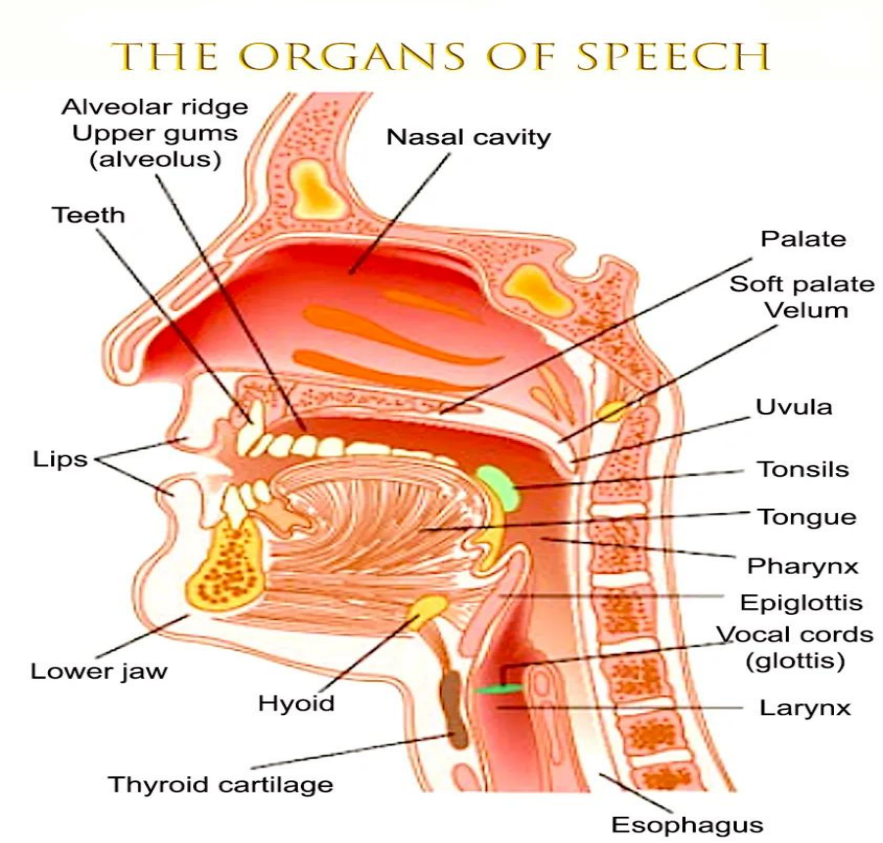
- Tongue
- Lips
- Teeth

ORGANS OF SPEECH

The major organs of speech are:

1. Lungs
2. Trachea (Windpipe)
3. Larynx (Voice Box)
4. Vocal Cords
5. Pharynx (Throat)
6. Tongue
7. Teeth

8. Lips
9. Alveolar Ridge
10. Hard Palate
11. Soft Palate (Velum)
12. Uvula
13. Nasal Cavity
14. Oral Cavity (Mouth)



DESCRIPTION OF EACH ORGAN

1. Lungs

The lungs supply the air needed for speaking.

Function:
They provide the air used in producing speech sounds.

2. Trachea (Windpipe)

This is the tube through which air travels from the lungs to the throat.

Function:
It carries air to the larynx.

3. Larynx (Voice Box)

The larynx is found in the throat.

Function:
It contains the vocal cords and helps produce voice.

4. Vocal Cords

These are two small folds inside the larynx.

Function:
They vibrate to produce voiced sounds.

Examples:

- /b/
- /d/
- /g/
- /z/

5. Pharynx (Throat)

The pharynx is the passage behind the mouth.

Function:
It helps the sound travel from the larynx to the mouth.

6. Tongue

The tongue is the most active organ of speech.

Function:
It changes position to produce many consonants and vowels.

Examples:

- /t/
- /d/
- /l/
- /n/

7. Teeth

The upper teeth help in producing some sounds.

Function:
They work with the tongue or lower lip.

Examples:

- /f/
- /v/
-

8. Lips

The lips open, close, and round during speech.

Function:
They produce bilabial sounds.

Examples:

- /p/
- /b/
- /m/

9. Alveolar Ridge

This is the raised part just behind the upper teeth.

Function:
It helps produce sounds such as:

- /t/
- /d/
- /s/
- /z/
- /n/
- /l/

10. Hard Palate

This is the hard front part of the roof of the mouth.

Function:
It helps produce sounds like /j/.

11. Soft Palate (Velum)

This is the soft back part of the roof of the mouth.

Function:
It controls whether air passes through the mouth or nose.

Examples:

- /k/
- /g/
- /ŋ/

12. Uvula

The uvula hangs at the back of the mouth.

Function:
It helps close the nasal passage during speech.

13. Nasal Cavity

This is the inside of the nose.

Function:
It allows air to pass through during nasal sounds.

Examples:

- /m/
- /n/
- /ŋ/

14. Oral Cavity (Mouth)

This is the space inside the mouth.

Function:
It shapes most speech sounds.

TABLE OF SOME ORGANS AND THE SOUNDS THEY PRODUCE

Organ	**Example Sounds**
Lips	/p/, /b/, /m/
Teeth and Lip	/f/, /v/
Tongue and Alveolar Ridge	/t/, /d/, /s/, /z/, /l/, /n/
Tongue and Soft Palate	/k/, /g/, /ŋ/
Nose	/m/, /n/, /ŋ/

SUMMARY

The organs of speech are the parts of the body that help us produce speech sounds. They include the lungs, larynx, vocal cords, tongue, lips, teeth, palate, nose, and other organs. Each organ performs a special function in speech production.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Draw and label the organs of speech.
2. Write the function of any eight organs of speech.
3. State the organs used in producing the following sounds:
    - /p/
    - /f/
    - /t/
    - /k/
    - /m/

Date	
Topic	THE ENGLISH ALPHABET AND SPECH SOUND
Learning Objectives	By the end of the lesson, students should be able to: 1. Define the English alphabet. 2. Identify uppercase and lowercase letters. 3. Define the terms **speech** and **sound**. 4. Explain the relationship between alphabet letters and speech sounds. 5. State the English vowel and consonant sounds. 6. Identify phonetic symbols representing English speech sounds.
Insight	The teacher asks: • How many letters are there in the English alphabet? • Can one letter produce more than one sound? • Do all words sound exactly the way they are written? Examples: • **cat** • **city** • **cake** Students observe that the letter **C** has different sounds. The teacher explains that while English has only **26 letters**, it has **44 speech sounds**. .
Key words/New terms	• Introduction to the English Alphabet • Uppercase and Lowercase Letters • Meaning of Speech and Sound • Relationship between Alphabet and Speech Sounds • The English Sound System (Vowels and Consonants) .
Application .	• Sample of the letters of the English alphabet

Summary	The English alphabet consists of **26 letters** used in writing English. These letters are written in **uppercase (capital)** and **lowercase (small)** forms. Speech is the use of spoken language to communicate, while speech sounds are the individual sounds produced by the organs of speech. English has **about 44 speech sounds**, represented by **phonetic symbols**, and these are divided into **20 vowel sounds** and **24 consonant sounds**.
Student engagement: i. What have I learnt? ii. Skills acquired	
My Question(s)/Evaluation	i.
Action	

MEANING OF THE ENGLISH ALPHABET

The **English alphabet** is the set of **26 letters** used to write the English language.

These letters are divided into:

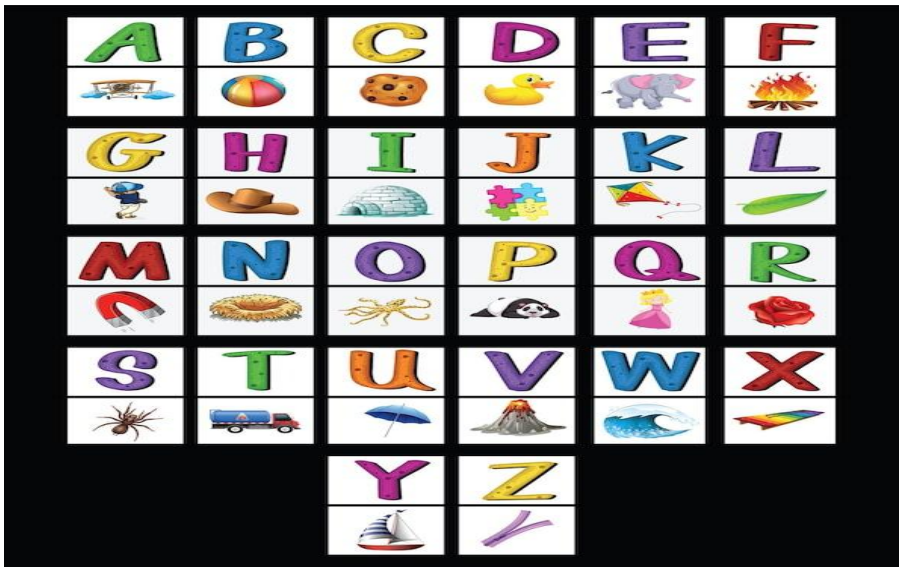
- Uppercase (Capital Letters)
- Lowercase (Small Letters)

The English Alphabet

Uppercase	**Lowercase**
A	a
B	b
C	c
D	d
E	e
F	f
G	g
H	h
I	i
J	j
K	k
L	l
M	m
N	n
O	o
P	p
Q	q

Uppercase	Lowercase
R	r
S	s
T	t
U	u
V	v
W	w
X	x
Y	y
Z	Z







USES OF THE UPPERCASE LETTERS

Uppercase letters are used:

- At the beginning of a sentence.
- For names of people.

Example:

John is a good boy.

- For places.

Example:

Abuja is the capital of Nigeria.

- For days and months.

Examples:

Monday

January

- For titles.

Example:

Dr. Musa

Mrs. Bello

USES OF LOWERCASE LETTERS

Lowercase letters are used:

- For ordinary words.
- Within sentences after the first word.
- For most common nouns.

Example:

The boy is reading a book.

DEFINITION OF SPEECH

Speech is the expression of thoughts, feelings, and ideas through spoken language.

Speech is what we produce when we speak.

DEFINITION OF SOUND

A **sound** is a noise produced by the organs of speech.

In English Language, a speech sound is the smallest unit of spoken language.

Examples:

/p/

/b/

/t/

/a/

Relationship Between Alphabet and Speech Sounds

Many students think letters and sounds are the same.

They are not.

Alphabet

- Alphabet refers to the written letters.
- English has **26 letters**.

Examples:

A, B, C, D

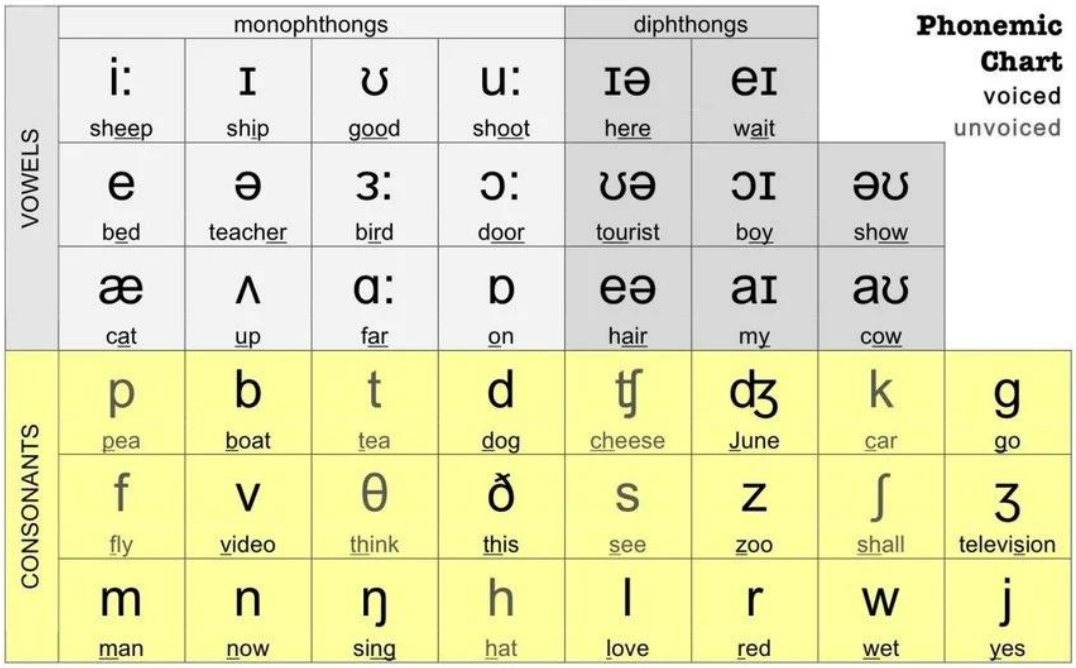
Speech Sounds

Speech sounds are the sounds we hear when words are spoken.

English has approximately **44 speech sounds**.

Examples:

/æ/, /ʒ/, /ɔ/, /ʧ/, /ɵ/, /ʤ/, /e/, /ei/



IMPORTANT DIFFERENCES BETWEEN ALPHABETS AND SPEECH SOUNDS

S/N	Alphabet	Speech Sound
1.	Written	Spoken
2.	26 letters	About 44 sounds
3.	Represented by ordinary letters	Represented by phonetic symbols

4.	Used for writing	Used for pronunciation

Examples

Word	Alphabet Letters	Speech Sounds
Cat	C A T	/kæt/
Fish	F I S H	/fɪʃ/
Phone	P H O N E	/fəʊn/
Ship	S H I P	/ʃɪp/

Notice:

The word **ship** has four letters but only three speech sounds:

/ʃ/ /ɪ/ /p/

THE ENGLISH SOUND SYSTEM

The English language has about **44 speech sounds**.

They are divided into:

1. Vowel sounds
2. Consonant sounds

VOWEL SOUNDS

A vowel sound is produced without any obstruction of air.

English has **20 vowel sounds**.

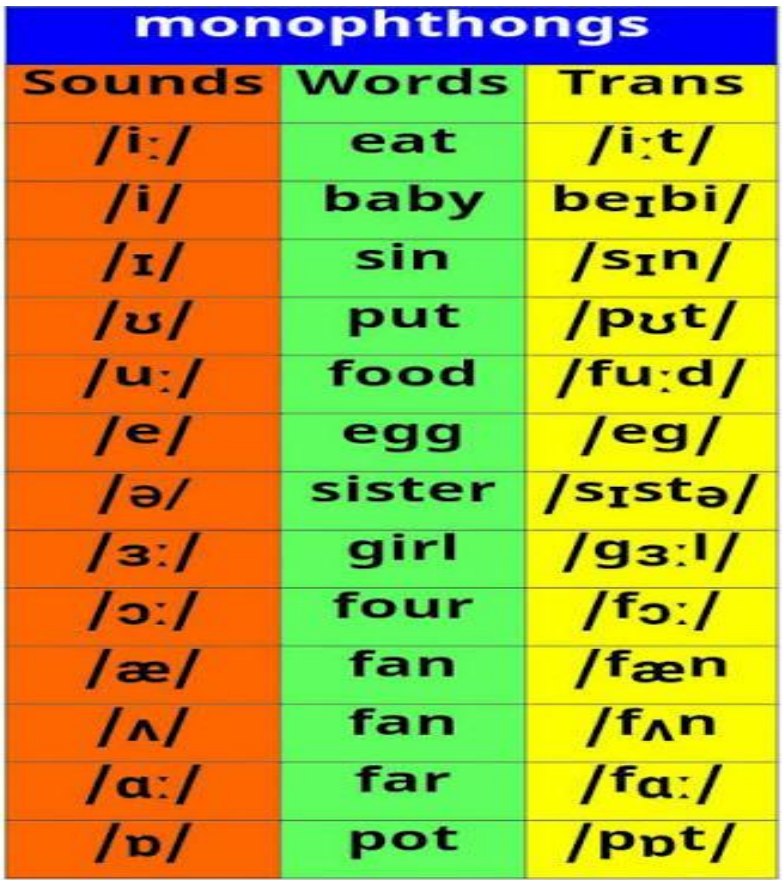
They are divided into:

- 12 Pure Vowels (Monophthongs)
- 8 Diphthongs

THE 12 PURE VOWELS (MONOPHTHONGS)

Symbol	Example
/iː/	S<u>ee</u>
/ɪ/	S<u>i</u>t

Symbol	Example
/e/	Pen
/æ/	Cat
/ɑː/	Father
/ɒ/	Hot
/ɔː/	Ball
/ʊ/	Book
/uː/	Food
/ʌ/	Cup
/ɜː/	Bird
/ə/	about



monophthongs		
Sounds	Words	Trans
/iː/	eat	/iːt/
/i/	baby	beɪbi/
/ɪ/	sin	/sɪn/
/ʊ/	put	/pʊt/
/uː/	food	/fuːd/
/e/	egg	/eg/
/ə/	sister	/sɪstə/
/ɜː/	girl	/gɜːl/
/ɔː/	four	/fɔː/
/æ/	fan	/fæn
/ʌ/	fan	/fʌn
/ɑː/	far	/fɑː/
/ɒ/	pot	/pɒt/

THE EIGHT DIPHTHONGS

Symbol	Example
/eɪ/	face
/aɪ/	time
/ɔɪ/	boy
/əʊ/	go
/aʊ/	house
/ɪə/	ear
/eə/	hair
/ʊə/	pure *(in accents where distinct)*

CONSONANT SOUNDS

A consonant sound is produced when the flow of air is partly or completely blocked.

English has **24 consonant sounds**.

THE 24 CONSONANT SYMBOLS

Symbol	Example
/p/	pen
/b/	boy
/t/	ten
/d/	dog
/k/	cat
/g/	goat
/f/	fan
/v/	van
/θ/	think
/ð/	this
/s/	sun
/z/	zoo

Symbol	Example
/ʃ/	shoe
/ʒ/	television
/h/	hat
/tʃ/	chair
/dʒ/	jam
/m/	man
/n/	net
/ŋ/	sing
/l/	leg
/r/	red
/j/	yes
/w/	we

Summary Table

English Sound System
44 Speech Sounds
20 Vowels
24 Consonants

Summary

The English alphabet consists of **26 letters** used in writing English. These letters are written in **uppercase (capital)** and **lowercase (small)** forms. Speech is the use of spoken language to communicate, while speech sounds are the individual sounds produced by the organs of speech. English has **about 44 speech sounds**, represented by **phonetic symbols**, and these are divided into **20 vowel sounds** and **24 consonant sounds**.

Assignment

1. Write the 26 English alphabet letters in both uppercase and lowercase forms.
2. State five differences between alphabet letters and speech sounds.
3. Write the 20 English vowel symbols with one example word each.
4. Write the 24 English consonant symbols with one example word each.

5. Transcribe the following words using phonetic symbols:
    - cat
    - book
    - fish
    - boy
    - school

WEEK 5-6

Date	
Topic	WORD FORMATION
Learning Objectives	At the end of the lesson, students should be able to: 1. Explain the meaning of word formation. 2. Define a morpheme. 3. Form simple two-letter and three-letter words. 4. Distinguish between words, phrases, sentences, and paragraphs. 5. Explain the meanings of homonyms, homophones, palindromes, and synonyms.
Insight	The teacher asks: • What do we get when we join letters together? • What do we get when we join words together? • Can a sentence consist of only one word? • Can different words have the same meaning? The teacher explains that language is built step by step—from letters to morphemes, words, phrases, sentences, and paragraphs.
Key words/New terms	Morphemes, palindrome, homonyms, synonyms, prefix, suffix
Application	**Word formation** in linguistics focuses on processes such as derivation, compounding, clipping, blending, borrowing, acronym formation, and conversion.
Summary	Word formation is the process of creating words in a language. The smallest meaningful unit of language is the **morpheme**. Letters combine to form **words**, words combine to form **phrases**, phrases develop into **sentences**, and related sentences make up a **paragraph**. Learners also enrich their vocabulary by understanding **homonyms** (same spelling and pronunciation, different meanings), **homophones** (same pronunciation, different spellings or meanings), **palindromes** (words that read the same

	forwards and backwards), and **synonyms** (words with similar meanings).
Student engagement: iii. What have I learnt? iv. Skills acquired	
My Question(s)/Evaluation	i.
Action	

WORD FORMATION

Word formation is the process of creating or forming words in a language.

Words are formed by combining letters and meaningful parts of words called **morphemes**.

Example

Play + er = player

Happy + ness = happiness

Un + kind = unkind

MORPHEMES

Definition

A **morpheme** is the smallest unit of language that has meaning.

A morpheme may be:

- a complete word
- part of a word

Examples

Word	**Morphemes**
Boy	boy
teacher	teach + er
unhappy	un + happy
replay	re + play
kindness	kind + ness

Types of Morphemes

1. Free Morphemes

These can stand alone as words.

Examples

book

play

boy

girl

house

2. Bound Morphemes

These cannot stand alone.

They must be attached to another word.

Examples

- un-
- re-
- dis-
- -er
- -ed
- -ing
- -ness
- -ful

Examples in words

rewrite

teacher

careful

playing

kindness

TWO-LETTER WORDS

Two-letter words contain only two letters.

Examples

- am
- an
- at
- as
- be
- by

- do
- go
- he
- if
- in
- is
- it
- me
- no
- of
- on
- or
- ox
- so
- to
- up
- us
- we

Importance of Two-letter Words

They help learners:

- read easily
- form simple sentences
- improve vocabulary

Example

I am in school.

He is at home.

THREE-LETTER WORDS

Three-letter words contain three letters.

Examples

cat

dog

boy

sun

pen

cup

hat

run

box

egg

map

top

bat

car

toy

bed

pig

fan

red

man

Example Sentences

The cat is sleeping.

The boy has a pen.

The sun is hot.

WORDS

A **word** is a group of letters that has meaning.

Examples

teacher

school

computer

beautiful

market

Nigeria

PHRASES

A **phrase** is a group of related words that does **not** express a complete thought.

It has **no finite verb** or does not express a complete idea.

Examples

- in the classroom
- under the table
- a beautiful girl
- after the lesson
- with my friend
- beside the river

Notice that these groups of words do not make complete sense by themselves.

SENTENCES

A **sentence** is a group of words that expresses a complete thought.

A sentence begins with a capital letter and ends with a punctuation mark.

Examples

The children are reading.

Mary went to school.

The teacher is teaching English.

We love our country.

Types of Sentences

Declarative

A declarative sentence is a statement that shares information, states a fact, or expresses an opinion. As the most common type of sentence in English, it typically follows a subject-verb word order and always ends with a period (or full stop) rather than a question mark or exclamation point.

The boy is happy.

Interrogative

An interrogative sentence is a sentence that asks a direct question and always ends with a question mark. Its primary purpose is to gather information, request assistance, or clarify a detail

Where are you going?

Imperative

An imperative sentence gives a command, makes a request, or offers advice. It typically starts with a verb and features an "implied you" as the subject.

Open your books.

Exclamatory

An exclamatory sentence is a statement that expresses a strong, sudden emotion (like excitement, shock, or anger) and always ends with an exclamation mark

What a beautiful day!

PARAGRAPHS

A **paragraph** is a group of related sentences discussing one main idea.

A paragraph usually contains:

- Topic sentence
- Supporting sentences
- Concluding sentence

Example Paragraph

MY SCHOOL

My school is one of the best schools in my town. The teachers are hardworking and friendly. We have a well-equipped library and science laboratory. The classrooms are neat and comfortable. I enjoy learning in my school because it provides a good environment for study.

HOMONYMS

Definition

Homonyms are words that have the **same spelling and pronunciation but different meanings**.

Examples

Word	**Meaning 1**	**Meaning 2**
bat	Animal	sports equipment

Word	Meaning 1	Meaning 2
bank	financial institution	side of a river
well	Healthy	water source
ring	Jewellery	sound of a bell
bark	dog's sound	tree covering

Example

The bat flew away.

He used a bat to play cricket.

HOMOPHONES

Definition

Homophones are words that have the **same pronunciation but different spellings and meanings**.

Examples

Word 1	Word 2
sun	Son
see	Sea
flour	Flower
pair	Pear
right	Write
hear	Here
buy	Bye
week	Weak
one	Won
knight	Night

Example

I can see the sea.

PALINDROMES

Definition

A **palindrome** is a word or sentence that reads the same forwards and backwards.

Examples

level

madam

refer

rotator

racecar

civic

radar

noon

mom

dad

Example

Madam

Reading from either direction gives the same word.

SYNONYMS

Definition

Synonyms are words that have the same or nearly the same meaning.

Examples

Word	**Synonym**
big	Large
small	Little
happy	Joyful
sad	Unhappy
begin	Start
end	Finish
clever	Intelligent

Word	Synonym
rich	Wealthy
quick	Fast
beautiful	Pretty

Example

The beautiful girl smiled.

The pretty girl smiled.

SUMMARY TABLE

Language Unit	Meaning
Morpheme	Smallest meaningful unit
Word	Group of letters with meaning
Phrase	Group of words without complete meaning
Sentence	Group of words expressing a complete thought
Paragraph	Group of related sentences

SUMMARY

Word formation is the process of creating words in a language. The smallest meaningful unit of language is the **morpheme**. Letters combine to form **words**, words combine to form **phrases**, phrases develop into **sentences**, and related sentences make up a **paragraph**. Learners also enrich their vocabulary by understanding **homonyms** (same spelling and pronunciation, different meanings), **homophones** (same pronunciation, different spellings or meanings), **palindromes** (words that read the same forwards and backwards), and **synonyms** (words with similar meanings).

ASSIGNMENT

1. Identify the morphemes in the following words:
    - teacher
    - unhappy
    - kindness
    - replay
    - beautiful

2. Write:
    - 15 two-letter words
    - 15 three-letter words
3. Use the following phrases to make meaningful sentences:
    - under the tree
    - after school
    - with my friends
    - in the classroom
    - beside the river
4. Write one paragraph (5–6 sentences) on **"My Best Friend."**
5. Give:
    - Five pairs of homonyms
    - Five pairs of homophones
    - Five palindromes
    - Ten pairs of synonym

WEEK 7-8

Date	
Topic	WORD CLASSES
Learning Objectives	At the end of the lesson, students should be able to: 1. Define word classes. 2. List the eight parts of speech. 3. Explain the functions of each part of speech. 4. Identify the parts of speech in simple sentences. 5. Construct sentences using each part of speech correctly.
Insight	The teacher asks the following questions: • What is the name of your school? • What are you doing now? • Is **school** the same kind of word as **read**? • Can all English words perform the same function?
Key words/New terms	Noun, name, action, verb, conjunction, interjection, adverb, preposition
Application	The teacher explains that English words perform different jobs in a sentence. These different groups are called **word classes** or **parts of speech**.
Summary	Word classes, also known as the **parts of speech**, are categories of words according to the jobs they perform in sentences. The traditional eight parts of speech are **noun, pronoun, verb, adjective, adverb, preposition, conjunction,** and **interjection**. Understanding these word classes helps learners construct correct and meaningful sentences, communicate effectively, and improve both spoken and written English.
Student engagement: v. What have I learnt? vi. Skills acquired	
My Question(s)/Evaluation	i.
Action	

MEANING OF WORD CLASSES

Word classes are groups of words that perform the same function in a sentence.

They are also called the **parts of speech**.

Every English word belongs to a particular word class depending on the work it performs in a sentence.

THE EIGHT PARTS OF SPEECH

The eight parts of speech are:

1. Noun
2. Pronoun
3. Verb
4. Adjective
5. Adverb
6. Preposition
7. Conjunction
8. Interjection

1. NOUN

Definition

A **noun** is the name of a person, animal, place, thing, or idea.

A noun tells us **who** or **what** we are talking about.

Types of Nouns

Proper Nouns

These are the specific names of people, places, or organizations.

Examples

- John
- Nigeria
- Lagos
- River Niger
- Unity School

Common Nouns

These are general names.

Examples

- boy

- girl
- city
- school
- teacher
- dog

Concrete Nouns

These are things we can see or touch.

Examples

- chair
- table
- pen
- book

Abstract Nouns

These are things we cannot see or touch.

Examples

- love
- honesty
- wisdom
- happiness
- courage

Collective Nouns

These refer to groups.

Examples

- team
- class
- family
- crowd
- flock

Sentence Examples

John is my friend.

The teacher entered the classroom.

Honesty is the best policy.

The team won the match.

2. PRONOUN

Definition

A **pronoun** is a word used in place of a noun to avoid unnecessary repetition.

Examples

I

you

he

she

it

we

they

me

him

her

us

them

Sentence Examples

Mary is absent because **she** is sick.

John and Peter are brothers. **They** are hardworking.

The teacher called **me**.

3. VERB

Definition

A **verb** is a word that expresses an action, an event, or a state of being.

It tells what someone or something does or is.

Examples

run

eat

write

sing

play

teach

jump

sleep

is

are

was

Sentence Examples

The pupils **read** every day.

The baby **slept** peacefully.

She **is** a nurse.

They **play** football after school.

4. ADJECTIVE

Definition

An **adjective** is a word that describes or qualifies a noun or pronoun.

It tells us more about a person, place, animal, or thing.

Examples

beautiful

tall

short

big

small

red

happy

intelligent

old

young

Sentence Examples

The **beautiful** girl won the competition.

The **red** car belongs to my father.

He bought a **large** house.

The pupils are **happy** today.

5. ADVERB

Definition

An **adverb** is a word that modifies a verb, an adjective, or another adverb.

It tells us:

- how
- when
- where
- how often
- to what extent

an action happens.

Examples

quickly

slowly

yesterday

today

here

there

always

never

carefully

very

Sentence Examples

The boy ran **quickly**.

She speaks **politely**.

They arrived **early**.

The teacher is **very** kind.

6. PREPOSITION

Definition

A **preposition** is a word that shows the relationship between a noun (or pronoun) and another word in the sentence.

It often indicates **position**, **direction**, **time**, or **place**.

Examples

in

on

under

behind

between

beside

near

into

from

through

before

after

Sentence Examples

The book is **on** the table.

The children are **in** the classroom.

The cat slept **under** the chair.

She arrived **before** noon.

7. CONJUNCTION

Definition

A **conjunction** is a word used to join words, phrases, or clauses.

Examples

and

but

or

because

although

since

if

while

so

yet

Sentence Examples

John and Mary are friends.

She studied hard **because** she wanted to pass.

You may stay **or** leave.

He is poor **but** honest.

8. INTERJECTION

Definition

An **interjection** is a word or expression that shows sudden emotion or feeling.

It is usually followed by an exclamation mark (!).

Examples

Wow!

Oh!

Hurrah!

Alas!

Ouch!

Bravo!

Hurray!

Oops!

Sentence Examples

Wow! That is wonderful.

Ouch! My leg hurts.

Hurrah! We won the competition.

Alas! The old man is dead.

SUMMARY TABLE

Part of Speech	Function	Example
Noun	Names a person, place, thing, animal, or idea	teacher, Lagos
Pronoun	Replaces a noun	he, she, they
Verb	Shows action or state	run, eat, is
Adjective	Describes a noun or pronoun	tall, beautiful
Adverb	Describes a verb, adjective, or another adverb	quickly, always
Preposition	Shows relationship or position	in, on, under
Conjunction	Joins words or sentences	and, but, because

Part of Speech	Function	Example
Interjection	Expresses emotion	wow!, alas!, ouch!

IDENTIFYING PARTS OF SPEECH

Example:

The intelligent boy answered the difficult question quickly.

Word	Part of Speech
The	Article (a type of determiner)
intelligent	Adjective
Boy	Noun
answered	Verb
The	Article
Difficult	Adjective
Question	Noun
Quickly	Adverb

CLASS EXERCISE

Identify the part of speech of the underlined words.

1. The **teacher** entered the classroom.
2. **She** is my sister.
3. The boys **played** football.
4. We saw a **beautiful** flower.
5. The baby cried **loudly**.
6. The book is **under** the table.
7. James came **because** he was invited.
8. **Hurray!** We have won the match.

SUMMARY

Word classes, also known as the **parts of speech**, are categories of words according to the jobs they perform in sentences. The traditional eight parts of speech are **noun, pronoun, verb, adjective, adverb, preposition, conjunction,** and **interjection**. Understanding these word classes helps learners construct correct and meaningful sentences, communicate effectively, and improve both spoken and written English.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write **10 nouns**, **10 pronouns**, **10 verbs**, **10 adjectives**, **10 adverbs**, **10 prepositions**, **10 conjunctions**, and **10 interjections**.
2. Construct **two meaningful sentences** using each part of speech.
3. Read the following paragraph and identify **five nouns, five verbs, three adjectives, three adverbs, three prepositions, two conjunctions, and one interjection**:

Yesterday, the hardworking pupils happily cleaned the classroom before the principal arrived. They arranged the desks neatly and decorated the walls with colourful charts. "Excellent!" exclaimed the principal, as he praised the students for their good work.

WEEK 9

Date	
Topic	**ARTICLES (DEFINITE AND INDEFINITE ARTICLES)**
Learning Objectives	By the end of the lesson, students should be able to: 1. Define articles. 2. Identify the two types of articles. 3. Explain the difference between definite and indefinite articles. 4. Use **a**, **an**, and **the** correctly in sentences. 5. State the functions and uses of articles. 6. Correct common mistakes in the use of articles.
Insight	The teacher displays the following objects: • a pen • an orange • the classroom door The teacher asks: • What is this? • Why do we say **a pen** but **an orange**? • Why do we say **the door** instead of **a door**?
Key words/New terms	The teacher explains that the words **a**, **an**, and **the** are called **articles**.
Application	• Explain the meaning and types of articles. • Display pictures and ask students to describe them using **a**, **an**, and **the**. • Give examples of correct and incorrect article usage. • Guide students through sentence-construction exercises.
Summary	Articles are words placed before nouns to indicate whether the noun is **specific** or **general**. English has three articles: **a**, **an**, and **the**. The indefinite articles (**a** and **an**) refer to non-specific singular countable nouns, while the definite article (**the**) refers to specific or previously identified nouns. Choosing the correct article depends

	on the **sound** that begins the following word and the meaning intended by the speaker or writer.
Student engagement: vii. What have I learnt? viii. Skills acquired	
My Question(s)/Evaluation	i.
Action	

ARTICLES (DEFINITE AND INDEFINITE)

Meaning of Articles

Articles are words placed before nouns to show whether the noun refers to a specific person, place, animal, or thing, or to any member of a group.

Articles help to make the meaning of a sentence clear.

There are **three articles** in English:

- **a**
- **an**
- **the**

These are grouped into **two types**.

TYPES OF ARTICLES

1. Definite Article
2. Indefinite Articles

1. THE DEFINITE ARTICLE

The definite article is **the**.

It refers to a **particular**, **specific**, or **already known** person, place, animal, or thing.

Examples

- the teacher
- the book
- the house
- the boy
- the river

Sentence Examples

- The teacher is teaching English.
- Please close the door.
- The girl who won the competition is my friend.
- We visited the museum yesterday.

Uses of the Definite Article (the)

1. To refer to a specific person or thing

Example

The boy wearing a blue shirt is my brother.

2. To refer to something already mentioned

Example

I saw a dog yesterday. **The dog** was very friendly.

3. Before unique objects

Examples

- the sun
- the moon
- the earth
- the sky
- the internet

Sentence:

The sun rises in the east.

4. Before rivers, seas, oceans, deserts, mountain ranges, and groups of islands

Examples

- the River Niger
- the Atlantic Ocean
- the Sahara Desert
- the Alps

5. Before superlative adjectives

Examples

- the tallest boy
- the best student
- the oldest teacher

Sentence:

Grace is the best student in the class.

6. Before ordinal numbers

Examples

- the first
- the second
- the third

Sentence

He came first in the competition.

7. Before musical instruments

Examples

She plays the piano.

He plays the guitar.

8. Before names of newspapers and some organizations

Examples

- The Guardian
- The Punch
- the United Nations

FUNCTIONS OF THE DEFINITE ARTICLE

The definite article:

- identifies a particular noun.
- makes the meaning specific.
- helps listeners know exactly which person or thing is being discussed.
- avoids confusion in communication.

2. THE INDEFINITE ARTICLES

The indefinite articles are:

- **a**
- **an**

They refer to **any one** person, place, animal, or thing rather than a particular one.

The Article "A"

"A" is used before words beginning with a **consonant sound**.

Examples

- a boy
- a girl
- a pen
- a book
- a table
- a university *(because "university" begins with the consonant sound /j/)*

Sentence Examples

I bought a pen.

She is a doctor.

He saw a bird.

The Article "An"

"An" is used before words beginning with a **vowel sound**.

Examples

- an egg
- an orange
- an elephant
- an apple
- an umbrella
- an hour *(the "h" is silent, so the word begins with a vowel sound)*

Sentence Examples

She ate an apple.

He waited for an hour.

I saw an elephant at the zoo.

IMPORTANT RULE

Articles depend on **sound**, **not simply the first letter**.

Examples

Correct	**Reason**
a university	Begins with the consonant sound /j/
a European country	Begins with the consonant sound /j/
an hour	The "h" is silent, so it begins with a vowel sound
an honest man	The "h" is silent
an honour	The "h" is silent

USES OF INDEFINITE ARTICLES

1. To introduce a noun for the first time

Example

I bought a book.

2. To refer to one person or thing among many

Example

She is a nurse.

3. To describe a person's occupation

Examples

He is a teacher.

She is an engineer.

4. To indicate one item

Examples

A mango

An orange

A pencil

5. In expressions of quantity

Examples

A hundred

A thousand

A dozen

FUNCTIONS OF INDEFINITE ARTICLES

Indefinite articles:

- introduce nouns for the first time.
- refer to non-specific nouns.
- indicate one member of a group.
- help identify occupations.
- make sentences grammatically complete.

DIFFERENCE BETWEEN DEFINITE AND INDEFINITE ARTICLES

Definite Article	**Indefinite Articles**
The	a, an
Refers to a particular noun	Refers to any noun of its kind
Used for specific persons or things	Used for general or non-specific persons or things
Used with singular and plural nouns	Used only with singular countable nouns

EXAMPLES

General:

A boy entered the classroom.

Specific:

The boy is my brother.

General:

She bought an orange.

Specific:

The orange is very sweet.

COMMON ERRORS

❌ He is **an university** student.

✓ He is **a university** student.

❌ She waited for **a hour**.

✓ She waited for **an hour**.

❌ The honesty is important.

✓ Honesty is important.

(Do not use "the" with abstract nouns when speaking generally.)

❌ I bought the book yesterday.

(Incorrect if the listener does not know which book.)

✓ I bought a book yesterday.

SUMMARY TABLE

Article	Type	Used Before	Example
A	Indefinite	Consonant sounds	a boy
An	Indefinite	Vowel sounds	an egg
The	Definite	Specific nouns	the teacher

CLASS EXERCISE

Choose the correct article.

1. I have (a, an) umbrella.
2. He is (a, an) university student.
3. Please open (a, an, the) window.
4. She waited for (a, an) hour.
5. We crossed (a, an, the) River Niger.
6. Musa is (a, an) intelligent boy.
7. (A, An, The) moon shines at night.

8. My mother bought (a, an) orange.

SUMMARY

Articles are words placed before nouns to indicate whether the noun is **specific** or **general**. English has three articles: **a**, **an**, and **the**. The indefinite articles (**a** and **an**) refer to non-specific singular countable nouns, while the definite article (**the**) refers to specific or previously identified nouns. Choosing the correct article depends on the **sound** that begins the following word and the meaning intended by the speaker or writer.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write **15 nouns** and use each with the correct article (**a**, **an**, or **the**) where appropriate.
2. Construct:
    - Five sentences using **a**
    - Five sentences using **an**
    - Five sentences using **the**
3. Correct the following:
    - She is a honest girl.
    - I saw an university.
    - Sun rises in east.
    - He bought the pen yesterday. *(Assume the pen has not been mentioned before.)*
    - We waited for a hour.
4. Write **10 words** that take **a** and **10 words** that take **an**, and explain why each article is correct.